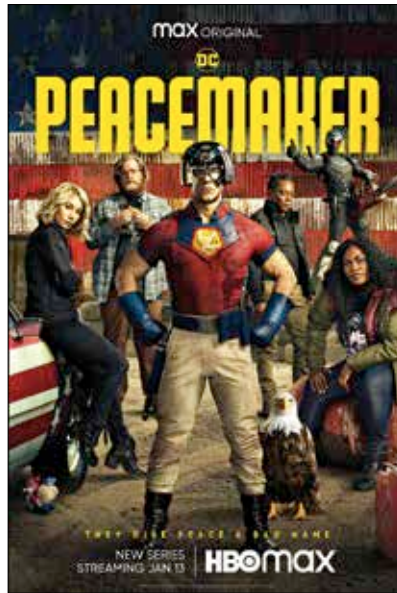


TV SHOW

Peacemaker

★★★★☆ | Nobody was expecting Suicide Squad's Peacemaker of all people to get his own standalone spin-off show but here it is, and it's actually surprisingly good. It's been a while since the show dropped, but we'll try to avoid spoilers anyway in case you haven't watched the show yet. Now if you've watched the recent Suicide Squad movie, then you probably thought that the Peacemaker was dead. Turns out he wasn't; just seriously injured. He wakes up and finds himself in a hospital, and also, he's apparently a free man now. We say apparently because it only looks like he's free, he's actually been roped into some other secret op by Amanda Waller. The show gives us a different side of the Peacemaker; the guy who wants peace no matter the cost is not quite the same after killing Rick Flag, and is haunted by



it. The show also serves as an origin story of sorts for the Peacemaker. Turns out, Peacemaker's dad is a real piece of work, and from the very first moment you see his dad, played brilliantly by Robert Patrick, everything about Peacemaker suddenly makes a lot more sense. Coming

to the main plot itself, it's aliens taking over the world. Yes, it's a bit generic, but they've executed it pretty well, and there's a few plot twists in there too to throw viewers off. Over the course of the show, we see some serious character growth, not just in Peacemaker, but the rest of the characters as well. Which brings us to the cast. John Cena does a fantastic job as the Peacemaker. There are also a few other familiar faces from the Suicide Squad movie, including Emilia Harcourt played by Jennifer Holland, and John Economos played by Steve Agee. Both of them also do a great job in the show and are joined by Clemson Murn played by Chukwudi Iwujii and Leota Adebayo played by Danielle Brooks, who both play central roles in the show. Finally, saving the best for last, there's Vigilante (secret identity Adrian Chase), Peacemaker's sidekick played by Freddie Stroma who stole the show. There's also a cameo from a certain superhero group in the movie, and we'll leave you at that. Can't wait for season 2.

—Manish Rajesh

MANHWA

The Legend of the Northern Blade

★★★★★ | Most of you might be familiar with manga, but have you heard of manhwa and manhua? Maybe not, but they're essentially online webcomics, which are read from left to right, and are usually in full colour. One of the reasons why I personally enjoy them more than manga. The main difference between manhwa and manhua is their country of origin, with manhwa being Korean, and manhua being Chinese. We came across a particular one called The Legend of the Northern Blade, and we were quite frankly, blown away. The art, the story, the characters, everything in the Northern Blade is top notch. It almost seems odd



trying to describe how good an action scene looked on a static image, but the Northern Blade certainly manages to convey that impact and more. The story itself is about Jin Mu-Won, the last surviving member of the Northern Heavenly Sect. The Northern Heavenly Sect was tasked with protecting the lands from the Silent Night (think of them as a terrorist group of sorts), and they actually managed to almost completely eradicate them. During this time of peace, the Northern Heavenly

Sect is accused of conspiring with the Silent Night, and it's disbanded. The leader – Jin Mu-Won's father, also known as the Northern Wall – is executed. All the martial art teachings are either stolen or destroyed, and Jin Mu-Won is left to live his days alone in the Northern Heavenly Sect, without the worry that he might learn martial arts to take revenge, since no knowledge was left behind. Of course, that's not what happens, Jin Mu-Won still manages to learn martial arts, we're not going to tell you how, you're going to have to read the manhwa to find out. Eventually, he becomes famous enough to earn the moniker "Northern Blade". This is the story of his revenge against those that betrayed the Northern Heavenly Sect. As of writing this, The Legend of the Northern Blade is still being updated, with around 130 chapters out so far. We're waiting with baited breath every week for new chapters and really can't recommend this enough.

—Manish Rajesh